

Salina, KS → Leesburg, FL

Family move · departing **Friday, July 3, 2026** (July 4th weekend) · traveling with cats · 4 days / 3 nights
Convoy: 2018 Tacoma TRD Off-Road towing a 2,300 lb T-bucket roadster · 2024 Land Cruiser · 10-month-old aboard
Easiest-towing route: I-135 → I-35 → I-40 → I-22 → I-65 → US-231 → I-10 → I-75 (Exit 329, Wildwood). ~1,555 mi · ~23.5 hrs · **\$0 tolls**. Avoids Monteagle Mountain, the Appalachian grades, and Atlanta entirely.

Total miles	Driving time	Tolls	Est. fuel (both vehicles)
1,555 mi	~23.5 hrs	\$0	~\$645 (budget \$650-700)

■ One breath before the road: four days, ~330-470 mi each. You built in margin. Tires checked, baby buckled - you've got this.

DAY 1 Salina, KS → Oklahoma City, OK

~290 mi · ~4.5 hrs
I-135 S → I-35 S

SLEEP — Oklahoma City (I-40 / Meridian cluster)

Hotel	Area	\$/room	Notes
Home2 Suites OKC Airport Hilton	I-40/I-44 Meridian	\$152	Cats OK; RV/bus/truck parking; all-suite+kitchen; Hotels.com
TownePlace Suites OKC Airport Marriott	Meridian Row	\$150	Cats OK; flat lot; suite+kitchen; Hotels.com
Residence Inn OKC Airport Marriott	I-40 @ Meridian	\$168	Cats OK; lot fills early; suite+kitchen; Hotels.com

FUEL STOPS

Wichita, KS (I-135 ~mi 90): QuikTrip - last KS fuel
Perry, OK (I-35 Exit 185): Love's - top off (OK cheapest)
Edmond, OK: Pilot/OnCue - final top-off before OKC

REST / DIAPER BREAKS

Wichita QuikTrip (~1.5 hrs in): first diaper stop
OK Welcome Center, I-35 SB mile 225: 24/7 restrooms, pet area

FOOD

Cracker Barrel - Edmond (I-35 Exit 137): big lot, high chairs
Braum's (KS/OK): burgers + ice cream, fast & kid-friendly
QuikTrip: fast grab-and-go with a baby

DAY 2 Oklahoma City, OK → Memphis, TN

~465 mi · ~7 hrs
I-40 E (via Little Rock)

SLEEP — Memphis EAST - Germantown Pkwy / I-40 Exit 16 (not downtown)

Hotel	Area	\$/room	Notes
Hilton Garden Inn Wolfchase Hilton	I-40 Exit 16, Cordova	\$176	Cats OK; big standalone lot; indoor pool; Hotels.com
Hampton Inn & Suites Wolfchase Hilton	I-40 Exit 16, Bartlett	\$172	Cats OK; large free lot; FREE bkfst; Hotels.com
Residence Inn Memphis Germantown Marriott	Germantown / Wolfchase	\$180	Cats OK; smaller lot (fills eve); suite+kitchen; Hotels.com

FUEL STOPS

Henryetta, OK (I-40 Exit 237): Love's - cheap OK fuel

N. Little Rock, AR (Exit 161): Pilot/Flying J - huge lot

West Memphis, AR (Exit 280): Love's - last AR fuel, fill before TN

REST / DIAPER BREAKS

Sallisaw, OK (I-40 Exit 308): travel center deli + restrooms

Alma/Fort Smith, AR: AR Welcome Center - clean stretch

West Memphis, AR: Love's - last stop before the river

FOOD

Cracker Barrel - Alma, AR (I-40 Exit 13): mid-day sit-down reset

Cracker Barrel / Chick-fil-A - Little Rock: reliable dinner

Whataburger (OK/AR): fast, easy trailer parking

Longest day - plan 4 stops and one real sit-down meal to reset everyone.

DAY 3 Memphis, TN → Montgomery, AL

~330 mi · ~5 hrs
I-22 E → I-65 S

SLEEP — Montgomery (East Blvd / I-85 EastChase cluster)

Hotel	Area	\$/room	Notes
TownePlace Suites Montgomery EastChase Marriott	I-85 EastChase	\$156	Cats OK; flat lot often empty (best for trailer); Hotels.com
Hilton Garden Inn Montgomery East Hilton	I-85 Exit 4	\$150	Cats OK; free surface lot; pool; Hotels.com
Hampton Inn & Suites EastChase Hilton	I-85 @ EastChase	\$168	Cats OK; buses OK but lot on steep hill; Hotels.com

FUEL STOPS

Tupelo, MS (I-22 ~Exit 85): Love's/Pilot - 2nd-cheapest (\$3.81)

Birmingham, AL (I-65): Pilot/Flying J before run south

Buc-ee's Leeds & Athens are OFF your route - skip them.

REST / DIAPER BREAKS

Byhalia/Holly Springs, MS: MS Welcome Center / Love's

Tupelo, MS (~1.5 hrs in): Love's + retail - diaper + lunch hub

Pelham/Alabaster, AL (I-65): Pilot/Love's before Montgomery

FOOD

Cracker Barrel - Tupelo, MS: clean, high chairs, mid-leg lunch

Chick-fil-A - Birmingham: best fast-with-a-baby option

Jim 'N Nick's Bar-B-Q (Birmingham): family-friendly, good parking

DAY 4 Montgomery, AL → Leesburg, FL ■

~470 mi · ~7 hrs
US-231 → I-10 E → I-75 S (Exit 329)

SLEEP — Arrival - Leesburg, FL (first-month base)

Hotel	Area	\$/room	Notes
I-75 S to Exit 329 (Wildwood, SR-44)	then ~20 min local	--	To 34407 Shadewood Circle, Leesburg FL 34788 - toll-free; no FL Turnpike

FUEL STOPS

Dothan, AL (US-231): Love's/Pilot - last AL fuel

Lake City, FL (I-10/I-75, Exit 427): Love's - major truck stop

Ocala, FL (I-75 ~Exit 358): Pilot/RaceTrac - final top-off

REST / DIAPER BREAKS

Troy, AL (US-231, ~1 hr in): early diaper stop

Tallahassee/Madison, FL (I-10): FL Welcome Center - 24/7

Lake City, FL (I-75 Exit 427): last big clean stop

FOOD

Cracker Barrel - Dothan, AL (US-231): first real meal of the day

Cracker Barrel - Lake City, FL (I-75 Exit 427): late-lunch reset

Chick-fil-A - Tallahassee, FL (off I-10): fast & spotless

Note: the Ocala Buc-ee's is NOT open yet (delayed to ~2028). There is no Buc-ee's on this route - Love's & FL Welcome Centers are your substitutes. Day 4 is long but dead flat.

FUEL & COST SUMMARY

Item	Estimate	Basis
Tacoma (towing)	~\$400	~15 mpg, ~104 gal
Land Cruiser (hybrid)	~\$245	~24.5 mpg, ~64 gal
Fuel combined	~\$645	budget \$650-700
Hotels (3 nights x 2 rooms)	~\$968	Jul 4th wknd; cats OK @ \$152/\$176/\$156
Tolls	\$0	toll-free corridor
TRIP TOTAL (fuel + hotels)	~\$1,613	+ pet fees ~\$50-75/nt; food extra

Gas by state (early-June 2026 AAA): OK \$3.74 (cheapest) · MS \$3.81 · AR \$3.86 · AL \$3.89 · KS \$3.90 · FL \$3.91 · TN \$3.93. Buy big in OK & MS; top off before TN and FL. Hotel rates are July 2026 estimates - confirm crib & trailer parking when booking. Re-check gas prices the week you leave.